metropolis by the name of Harari. The capital of a liberated country will obviously not retain the name which was given to it by imperialist oppressors.' By lunchtime the following day, the GDR delegation arrived in Mozambique to cut deals on selling machine tools, textiles and chemical products.

Although Honecker had, in fact, no specific programme for Africa, his fevered activity cemented East Berlin as the main Warsaw Pact agency building up strong relations with liberation movements and helping to train and finance pro-Soviet Marxist cadres. During his travels, he succeeded in gaining endorsement for his bitter attacks against China while handing out solidarity 'donations' – such as DDM5 million to the ANC – which was enthusiastically accepted. The money was plucked from a hefty 'solidarity fund' used to bankroll liberation movements9 and finance periodicals including the monthly African Communist journal, the mouthpiece of the exiled South African Communist Party. Money was also directed to Sechaba, the official organ of the African National Congress of South Africa (a gesture never forgotten by Nelson Mandela) and to the South-West African People's Organisation of Namibia. 'Not surprisingly,' wrote Colin Legum, one of the finest contemporary writers on African politics, 'the East German-financed publications of these liberation movements keep up a campaign of vitriolic denunciation of West Germany whose leaders are accused of seeking to play NATO's imperialistic game in Africa. Their successful propaganda has done considerable damage to Bonn's standing in many African countries.'

Peter Foster, the British Ambassador to the GDR, watched Honecker's unremitting thrust into the Third World, which, as he noted, 'continued unabated with a stream of inward and outward visits and some new friendship agreements as the outward and visible signs of an industrious contribution to the subversion of Western interests and the development of new sources of raw materials'.10 When asked why such a cordial relationship had developed between the GDR and African states, Honecker said some people may find it hard to understand 'the fact that there are no racial barriers between us'.11 Elaborating, he believed the peoples of Africa thought 'we are meeting them man to man, on equal terms, and practicing solidarity. That is, if you like, a concrete result of our visits to some African